

Troodon

Troodon was a small but agile dinosaur, built like a bird and covered with feathers. About the weight of a child, it wasn't powerful enough to tackle large dinosaurs, but it was swift on its feet and adept at catching small animals in the undergrowth of woodlands. With an unusually large brain for a dinosaur and sharp eyes, *Troodon* seems to have been a quick-witted hunter with the lightning reactions and killer instinct of a cat.



ON THE CHASE

Long, slender legs and an athletic build made *Troodon* a fast sprinter, able to outrun small animals such as lizards and baby dinosaurs. The second toe on each foot had a large, sickle-shaped claw that *Troodon* may have used to pin down prey. The claw could swivel upward to stay off the ground while *Troodon* was running.

Troodon

TROH-o-don



- **When** 74–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** N. America
- **Habitat** Wooded plains
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Small animals and possibly plants

Troodon had unusual teeth with very jagged edges. Although small animals probably made up most of its diet, the teeth might also have been used for shredding leaves. The name *Troodon* means “wounding tooth.”



► 3-D VISION

Troodon's eyes, unlike those of most dinosaurs, faced forward rather than sideways. This gave it 3-D vision in the area seen by both eyes (as in humans). This special ability enabled Troodon to judge the distance to its prey before pouncing for the kill.

